pan-Islamism or sectarianism, and successive regimes—martial and civilian—had encouraged these impulses. Some of Pakistan's militants had turned on their former masters not long after 9/11. By the latter years of the decade a revolutionary ideology had fully taken hold among many established jihadis and a new generation of militants who had little if any affiliation with recognized outfits. Those belonging to this new generation often were more extreme and less nationalistic than the old guard, sometimes competing to outdo one another when it came to attacks in Pakistan in an attempt to build their reputations. The issue of waging war against the state became a major dividing line within the jihadi universe—cutting not only between outfits, but through some of them too. Lashkar's policy vis-à-vis attacking Pakistan remained at the opposite end of the spectrum from a host of other actors who were engaging in revolutionary jihad. But it was close to them geographically and operationally, which contributed to fluidity between them. Thus, Lashkar militants could be active in the revolutionary locus even if the group's formal policy was to avoid it.

Al-Qaeda promoted revolutionary jihad in Pakistan, a decision influenced by its ideology as well as the understanding that destabilizing the country would protect its own safe haven and create difficulties for America. It also focussed significant energies on the insurgency in Afghanistan. The US presence there blurred the lines between a classical jihad to liberate Muslim land and al-Qaeda's American-centric global jihad. This latter approach entailed not only fighting the US and its allies on open fronts like Afghanistan or Iraq, but also striking targets belonging to them wherever they may be found. By the latter years of this decade, al-Qaeda's global view of warfare was infusing an increasing number of militants who were looking to launch out-of-area attacks against American and allied interests. This signified the emergence of a global locus of activity among Pakistan's jihadis. Lashkar's fidayeen assault in Mumbai integrated the Indian and global loci. After several years during which the group's relevance as a militant outfit appeared in decline, despite its limited expansion in Afghanistan, the attacks also launched Lashkar onto the world stage.